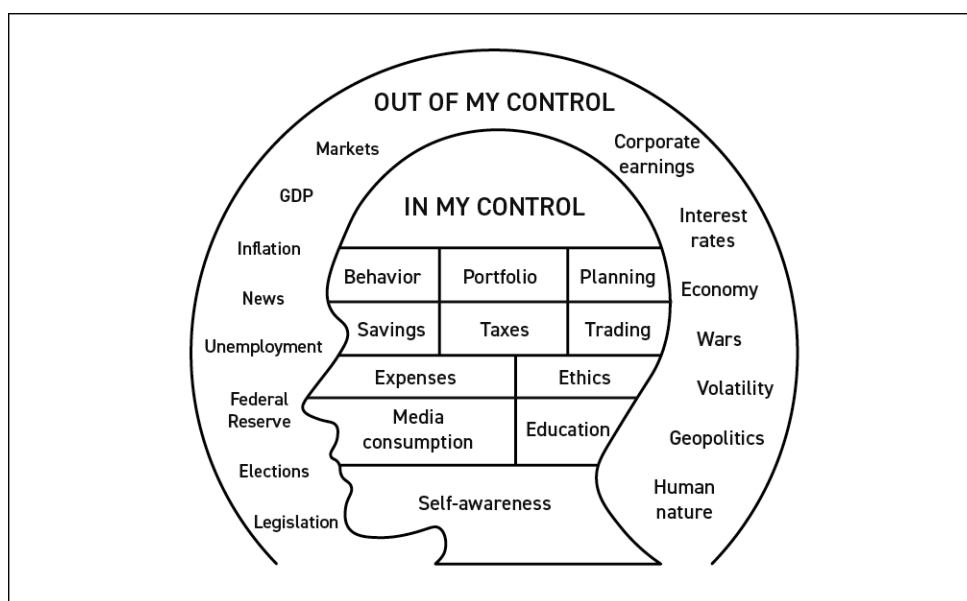


Understand What You Control

ONE OF THE secrets to failing well is understanding what is and is not in your control.

If you read the financial press or watch FinTV, take note of what the majority of coverage is about: Things you have absolutely no agency over. It's what I call *financial weather*. The daily noise, the *Sturm und Drang*, the angst-producing warnings are all about subjects beyond your control.

There is always scary news *somewhere*. The typical viewer response is an overreaction, such as “What do I do? What should I do?” This is the wrong approach. During periods of market volatility and stress, you should step back and consider the bigger picture. The most important thing you can learn—whether you are a trader, strategist, investor, or entrepreneur—is to recognize what you can and cannot control.



My experience has been to focus on what I can control and roll with the punches for what I cannot. When I do that, everything vastly improves.

Consider the following two lists—these are what is in and out of your control: